diplomacy became a regularized process with the development of diplomatic protocol and a series of rights, privileges and immunities attached to both diplomats and diplomatic activities.

Agenda: The agenda of traditional diplomacy was parochial and narrow in comparison to the present era. As White points out, the agenda was not only set by the relatively underdeveloped state of bilateral relationships between states but, more importantly, "the preoccupations of diplomacy reflected the preoccupations of political leaders". Perhaps, the significant contribution of traditional diplomacy came to be known, in a classic piece of overstatement, as the "century of peace" in Europe between 1815–1914.

Features of New Diplomacy

The golden age of diplomacy together with the balance of power system, which was soon followed by the drastic changes in international politics since 1918, came to be replaced by the so-called popular or new diplomacy. At the heart of this transition lay the suspicion of the public about the whole system of balance of power which they identified as the main cause of the First World War. They were also suspicious about the role of diplomacy with its tradition of secrecy. President Woodrow Wilson in his "14-points" agenda expressed this new view of diplomacy when he said: "Open Covenants of peace, openly arrived at, after which there shall be no private international understandings of any kind, but diplomacy shall proceed always frankly and in public view".[22]

A number of other factors also led to the change in the nature of diplomacy. The first and foremost among them is the development in technology and communication which, to a great extent, has changed the role of a diplomat. Even an ambassador of the highest level can no longer conduct his office as an independent agent, far removed from the seat of his government, as he once could and was expected to do. He has to shuffle between his own office and his home office. Improved communications have reduced the authority of a professional diplomat to make decisions and generally to 'represent' his own country. The superfast communication system has reduced the importance of the diplomats, and to a large extent,